Alexander Dao

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — **Santa Cruz**
Linguistics B.A., Computer Science Minor — **Winter 2027**

Thesis:
The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia — Completed Fall 2025, advised by Prof. Dustin A. Chacón

Relevant Coursework:
CSE 13S (C Programming)
CSE 40 (Machine Learning in Python)
CSE 101 (Introduction to Data Structures and Algorithms)
CSE 150 (Introduction to Computer Networks)
CSE 151 (Advanced Computer Networks)

Experience

treemarks.ai — **Stanford**
Intern Software Engineer — **Jul 2026 - Present**

- Currently developing a streamlined, configurable AI shell for TA workflows by adapting an existing Claude-based grading agent and implementing core features for practical deployment.

The American Prospect — **Santa Cruz**
Intern Contributor, Tech Beat — **Dec 2025 - May 2026**

- Technical research, writing, fact-checking, and data entry related to emerging AI technologies.
- Assigned to TAP's tech beat; wrote an article on the plight of young people seeking AI-usurped entry-level jobs

Paystand — **Santa Cruz**
Content Analytics Intern — **Jun 2024 – Jan 2025**

- Managed social presence (TikTok, YouTube, Twitter) and tracked viewer engagement metrics, reporting growth insights directly to the CEO's office.
- Analyzed platform performance data in Google Sheets/Excel to inform marketing strategies.

Additional Experience

Project: SpotiLytics — **Mountain View**
Data Engineer — **Jun 2026 – Present**

- The goal is to understand whether we can predict what songs Spotify users listen to on a given day of the week.
- Currently in development; built on a Python (Flask + SpotiPy) back end with a static GitHub page + vanilla JS to handle API handshakes.

Leadership & Activities

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA) — **Santa Cruz**
Member — **Feb 2025 - Present**

- Joint peer and staff-led mathematics, engineering, and sciences club @ UC Santa Cruz. Supports achievement for under-represented first-generation college students.

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) **Santa Cruz**
Member **Sep 2025 - Jun 2026**

- Society of engineers from all Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with clubs such as the National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) and MESA.

Peninsula Youth Sailing Foundation (PYSF) **Santa Cruz**
C420 Race Team Skipper **Jan 2016 - Jan 2022**

- Former competitive dinghy racer. Trained under former two-time world Snipe/Elliott 6m-class champion Molly O'Brien Vandemoer and 2008 470-class Olympic bronze medalist Udi Gal.

Skills & Interests

Technical: C, Python, TypeScript/JS, HTML, CSS
Language: English, Vietnamese, Japanese, Latin, Spanish (basic)
Laboratory: Psycholinguistics, Neurolinguistics, Advanced Computer Networking
Interests: Sketching, Cycling, Sailing, Hiking, Cooking